Topic 15 — Post-Independence India

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Community Development Programme | Etawah (इटावा) Pilot Project | Post-Independence India | Integration of Princely States | Integration of French and Portuguese Enclaves (Goa (गोवा), Pondicherry (पांडिचेरी)) | Constitution Making | States Reorganisation | Planning Commission (योजना आयोग) | Five-Year Plans | Early Foreign Policy (Panchsheel, NAM)

Sources baked in: NCERT Politics in India since Independence, Spectrum post-1947, Bipan Chandra, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Constituent Assembly), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — SRC members, CA chronology/committees, Etawah–CDP, PC→NITI, FYP slogans, princely cases, enclave merger routes (Goa/Pondicherry) **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — CCR filled on Junagadh / Hyderabad / J&K / Goa (Operation Vijay) / Andhra linguistic agitation; Etawah–CDP identity glue fixed; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** NITI Aayog (1 Jan 2015) as successor of Planning Commission only — not NITI index reports

15.1 Post-Independence overview

- Transfer of power was on **15 August 1947**.
- This chapter is the **state after 1947**: integration, Constitution, map, planning and village development.
- Three jobs ran together: **integrate about 562 princely states**, **write a Constitution**, and **build a planned economy and village programme**.
- The Constitution commenced on **26 January 1950**.
- The Planning Commission was set up in **March 1950**.
- CDP began on **2 October 1952**.
- Linguistic Andhra was formed on **1 October 1953**.
- The States Reorganisation Act came into force on **1 November 1956**.

Logic: Planning Commission is **1950**, not 1947. CDP is **1952**, not Etawah's 1948.

15.2 Integration of Princely States

In charge: States Department, July 1947 — **Sardar Patel** + **V.P. Menon**

- There were about **562/565** princely states.
- British **paramountcy lapsed** with the Independence Act (अधिनियम).
- States could accede to India or Pakistan, or in theory stand alone.

- **Butler Committee (1927)** studied paramountcy and princely-state relations with the Crown (Indian States Committee).
- **All India States People's Conference (1927)** organised Praja Mandal politics; **Nehru** (नेहरू) became its President in **1939**.
- The **Instrument of Accession** covered only **Defence, External Affairs and Communications**.
- A **Standstill Agreement** kept existing arrangements until merger.
- Most states signed quickly. Hard cases are below.
- Later came merger agreements and **privy purses**. Privy purses ended by the **26th Amendment, 1971**.
- The **1950 map** had **Part A** former Governor's provinces and **Part B** princely unions such as Hyderabad, J&K, Mysore (मैसूर) and PEPSU.
- **Part C** were Chief Commissioner's provinces. **Part D** was Andaman and Nicobar.
- This four-fold map lasted until **1956**.

Junagadh

Cause

- The Nawab of Junagadh wanted to accede to **Pakistan**, though the population (जनसंख्या) was largely Hindu and the state sat inside Kathiawar, surrounded by Indian territory.

Course

- Pakistan's acceptance of the Nawab's accession produced a crisis. Local resistance and India's diplomatic–administrative pressure forced a takeover of the state's administration.

Result

- A **plebiscite in 1948** confirmed accession to India. Junagadh is the classic **plebiscite** route — not Police Action.

Hyderabad

Cause

- The Nizam (निजाम) wanted **independence** rather than accession to India, while **Razakars** under **Kasim Razvi** backed that stand with communal militia pressure inside the state.

Course

- Negotiations failed. India launched **Operation Polo**, the Police Action, in **September 1948**, and Indian forces entered Hyderabad.

Result

- Hyderabad's resistance collapsed; the state acceded and later became a **Part B** state in the 1950 map. Hyderabad = **Police Action**, never the Junagadh plebiscite route.

Jammu and Kashmir

Cause

- A **tribal invasion** from the Pakistan side began in **October 1947**, threatening Srinagar and forcing Maharaja (महाराज) **Hari Singh** to seek Indian military help.

Course

- Hari Singh signed the **Instrument of Accession on 26 October 1947**. Indian troops were airlifted on **27 October** and held the Valley.

Result

- Accession brought J&K into India's constitutional orbit, but full internal settlement ran on a longer clock: IoA (**1947**) → Constitution of India (**26 January 1950**) → J&K Constituent Assembly ratification (**1954**) → J&K Constitution (**26 January 1957**).
- IoA ≠ full merger of all subjects on day one.

> **Logic:** Three routes — Junagadh **plebiscite**, Hyderabad **Polo**, Kashmir **IoA amid invasion**. IoA ≠ full merger on day one.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q103

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (Jammu & Kashmir Integration Chronology):** Maharaja Hari Singh signed Instrument of Accession (26 Oct 1947) → Constitution of India enforced (26 Jan 1950) → Accession ratified by J&K Constituent Assembly (Feb 1954) → J&K Constitution came into force (26 Jan 1957).

French Settlements — Chandernagore and the Pondicherry group (पुदुचेरी)

Places: Chandernagore (Bengal); Pondicherry, Karaikal, Mahe and Yanam (the four-enclave "Pondicherry group")

- Chandernagore voted to join India in a referendum on **19 June 1949**.
- France handed over de facto control on **2 May 1950**.
- The de jure transfer of sovereignty came on **9 June 1952**, under a Treaty of Cession signed in Paris.
- Chandernagore merged into **West Bengal** on **2 October 1954**, under the Chandernagore (Merger) Act, 1954.
- The remaining four (चातुर्याम) French enclaves voted for merger at the **Kizhoor referendum** on **18 October 1954**.
- France transferred them de facto on **1 November 1954**.
- The Treaty of Cession for Pondicherry, Karaikal, Mahe and Yanam was signed on **28 May 1956**.
- Ratification instruments were exchanged only on **16 August 1962**, completing the de jure merger.
- The **14th Constitutional Amendment, 1962**, made Pondicherry a Union Territory.

> **Logic:** Chandernagore is **not** part of the Pondicherry Union Territory. It joined **West Bengal** as a district; the other four enclaves became their **own UT**.

Portuguese Goa, Daman and Diu — Operation Vijay (1961)

Cause

- Portugal, unlike France, refused to negotiate a transfer of Goa, Daman and Diu. Diplomatic pressure through the 1950s failed.

Course

- India used the armed forces in **Operation Vijay**, on **18–19 December 1961**. Goa, Daman and Diu came under Indian control within about 36 hours, with light resistance.

Result

- The **12th Constitutional Amendment, 1962**, made Goa, Daman and Diu a Union Territory. **Goa became a full State on 30 May 1987.** Daman and Diu stayed a Union Territory.
- **Dadra and Nagar Haveli** was a separate Portuguese pocket. Local action brought it in during 1954, and it became a Union Territory under the **10th Amendment, 1961**.

> **Logic:** French enclaves joined by **referendum** (1949 and 1954). Goa joined by **military action** (**1961**). Dadra and Nagar Haveli is a **third, separate** case, also 1954.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (Territory Integration Route Match):** Chandernagore (Referendum 1949; merged into WB 1954) | Pondicherry group (Kizhoor referendum 1954; 14th Amendment 1962) | Goa, Daman & Diu (Operation Vijay Dec 1961; 12th Amendment 1962) | Dadra and Nagar Haveli (Local action 1954; 10th Amendment 1961).

Early foreign policy — brief (Panchsheel and NAM)

- Nehru's early foreign policy avoided joining either Cold War bloc.
- **Panchsheel** was signed with China on **29 April 1954**. Its five principles include mutual non-interference and peaceful coexistence.
- The **Non-Aligned Movement** held its first summit at **Belgrade in 1961**.
- The **Bandung Conference of 1955** echoed the Panchsheel principles for Asia and Africa. It was **not** the first NAM summit.

15.3 Constitution Making

Body: Constituent Assembly under the Cabinet Mission (कैबिनेट मिशन) plan. **First sitting: 9 December 1946**. Temporary President **Sachchidananda Sinha**, then **Rajendra Prasad**.

- The CA idea was pressed hard at **Faizpur Congress (कांग्रेस) (1936)**. The Assembly itself was elected under the **Cabinet Mission** (कैबिनेट मिशन) on roughly **one seat per 10 lakh** population.
- Strength was **389**. After Partition it was about **299**. Congress ~**208** seats; League ~**73**. **Jinnah** was **not** a member.
- Temporary chair **Sachchidananda Sinha** (**9 Dec 1946**); permanent President **Rajendra Prasad** (**11 Dec 1946**). Full sovereignty is keyed from **15 August 1947**.

- **G.V. Mavlankar** bridged British Central Assembly Speakership and free India's Lok Sabha (लोकसभा) Speakership.
- The Assembly worked **2 years 11 months 18 days**.
- Nehru moved the **Objective Resolution on 13 December 1946**. It was adopted on **22 January 1947**.
- The **National Flag** was adopted on **22 July 1947**. That date is **22 July 1947**, not 1948 and not January 1950.
- The **Drafting Committee** was set up on **29 August 1947**. Chairman was **B.R. Ambedkar** (बी.आर. अम्बेडकर).
- Other members were **N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar**, **Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar**, **K.M. Munshi** and **Syed Mohammad Saadulla**.
- **N. Madhava Rau** replaced B.L. Mitter. **T.T. Krishnamachari** replaced D.P. Khaitan.
- The Constitution was **adopted on 26 November 1949**.
- The last sitting was **24 January 1950**. It **commenced on 26 January 1950**.
- Order: CA first met (**December 1946**) → Drafting Committee (**August 1947**) → adopted (**26 November 1949**) → commenced (**26 January 1950**).

Key Constituent Assembly committees

Committee	Chairman
Union Constitution Committee	**Jawaharlal Nehru** (जवाहरलाल नेहरू)
Rules of Procedure (प्रक्रिया) Committee	**Rajendra Prasad**
Drafting Committee	**B.R. Ambedkar**
Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee	**J.B. Kripalani**

- Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights and Minorities was chaired by **Patel**.
- Union Powers was chaired by **Nehru**. Provincial Constitution was chaired by **Azad**.
- **Sardar Patel** said in the CA debates on separate electorates, *"Can you show me one free country… British element is gone, but they have left mischief behind."*
- **Jawaharlal Nehru** called Fundamental Rights *"a pledge to our people and a pact with the civilized world."*

> **Logic:** Adopted ≠ commenced. Flag **22 July 1947**. FR sub-committee = **Kripalani**, not Ambedkar.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q3):** Constitution-making chronology: Constituent Assembly first met (9 Dec 1946) → Appointment of Drafting Committee (29 Aug 1947) → Indian Constitution adopted and enacted (26 Nov 1949) → Date of commencement of Indian Constitution (26 Jan 1950).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q82)**: Constituent Assembly Committee Chairmen — Drafting Committee: Dr. B.R. Ambedkar; Steering Committee: Dr. Rajendra Prasad; Union Powers Committee: Jawaharlal Nehru; Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee: J.B. Kripalani.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q134)**: The Constituent Assembly adopted the National Flag of India on **22 July 1947**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q1)**: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel famously asked in the Constituent Assembly: *"Can you show me one free country where there are separate electorates? … But in this country it has been instituted by the British Government. The British Government is no longer here … they have left that legacy behind."*
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q73)**: Dr. S. Radhakrishnan (and Jawaharlal Nehru) characterized Fundamental Rights in the Constituent Assembly as *"a pledge to our people and a pact with the civilized world."*

15.4 Etawah Pilot Project (1948)

Place: Mahewa block, **Etawah district, Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश) Person: Albert Mayer** (American planner) **Year: 1948**

- It was multi-purpose village development in agriculture, health, education and cooperatives.
- It was a **block-level** laboratory, not a single scheme.
- The Planning Commission used it as the **blueprint of the Community Development Programme**.
- Do not confuse it with **Nilokheri** in East Punjab, later Haryana.
- Nilokheri was **S.K. Dey's** refugee township, remembered as *Mazdoor Manzil*.
- Dey later led Community Development at the Centre.
- Do not credit **Balwant Rai Mehta** of 1957 Panchayati Raj (पंचायती राज), or Gandhi (गांधी) Jayanti 1952, which is CDP.

> **Logic:** Etawah = **1948 Mayer UP**. CDP = **1952**. Nilokheri = **Dey**.

15.5 Community Development Programme (2 October 1952)

Launch: 2 October 1952 (Gandhi Jayanti), during the **First Five-Year Plan**. Initially **55** project areas.

- It was a nationwide rollout of the Etawah idea in agriculture, irrigation, health, education, roads and cooperatives.
- The field worker was the **Village Level Worker / Gram Sevak**.
- The **National Extension Service** of **1953** was cheaper and wider. It was less intensive than CDP blocks.
- Officials drove the programme. People's participation stayed weak.
- The **Balwant Rai Mehta Committee of 1957** recommended **three-tier Panchayati Raj**: Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti (पंचायत समिति) and Zila Parishad (जिला परिषद).
- **Nyaya Panchayat is not a Mehta tier**. Nyaya Panchayat was **not** a Mehta Committee tier.
- Rural programme order: CDP (**1952**) → DPAP (**1973–74**) → Food for Work (**1977**) → TRYSEM (**1979**).

> **Logic:** CDP ≠ 1948. First Plan home. TRYSEM and Food for Work are **1970s**, not Nehru-era CDP.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q134):** Rural development programme chronology: Community Development Programme (2 Oct 1952) → Drought Prone Areas Programme (1973–74) → Food for Work Programme (1977–78) → TRYSEM (Aug 1979).

15.6 States Reorganisation

Dhar Commission (1948)

- Chairman was **S.K. Dhar**.
- It recommended **administrative convenience**, not language, as the basis of provinces.

JVP Committee (1948–49)

- Members were **Nehru, Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya**.
- They called linguistic states **premature**.
- Sitaramayya sits on **JVP**, not on SRC.

Andhra, 1 October 1953

Cause

- Telugu speakers demanded a separate state from the Madras Presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी) after Independence. The **Dhar Commission** and **JVP Committee** had resisted language as the main basis, leaving the demand unresolved.

Course

- **Potti Sriramulu** undertook a fast unto death for a Telugu state and died in **December 1952**. Mass unrest followed across the Andhra region.

Result

- The Centre created **Andhra** on **1 October 1953** — India's first **linguistic** state (not Kerala, Madhya Pradesh or UP). The crisis forced appointment of the **States Reorganisation Commission** and the wider **1956** map redraw.

States Reorganisation Commission

- It was appointed in **1953**. The report came in **1955**.
- Members were **Fazl Ali** as Chair, **K.M. Panikkar** and **H.N. Kunzru**.
- SRC members included **K.M. Panikkar** and **H.N. Kunzru**; **K.T. Shah** and **Pattabhi Sitaramayya** were **not** on the Commission.
- SRC accepted language as a major basis but rejected "one language = one state" as a rigid formula.
- It stressed unity and administrative and financial viability.

States Reorganisation Act, 1956

- It came into force on **1 November 1956**.

- It made **14 states and 6 Union Territories**.
- It ended the Part A/B/C map and created **Zonal Councils**.

Later (one-line facts)

Year	What
1960	Bombay split → Maharashtra + Gujarat
1966	Punjab reorganised; **Haryana**; Himachal (हिमाचल) enlarged
1971–72	Himachal, Manipur, Tripura, Meghalaya (मेघालय) statehood
1987	Goa, Mizoram, Arunachal
2000	Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand
2014	**Telangana** (from Andhra)
2019	J&K and Ladakh (लद्दाख) as UTs (Art. 370 change — Polity)

> **Logic:** First linguistic state **Andhra 1953**. Full reorganisation **1956**. SRC trio = **Fazl Ali, Panikkar, Kunzru**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q71

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims)**: Members of the States Reorganisation Commission (SRC, 1953) headed by Justice Fazal Ali were **K.M. Panikkar** and **H.N. Kunzru**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q68)**: **Andhra State** was the first state created on linguistic lines in India on 1 October 1953, following the fast unto death of Potti Sreeramulu.

15.7 Planning Commission

Set up: Cabinet resolution, **15 March 1950**. Chairman: **Prime Minister (Nehru)**. Extra-constitutional — **not** Article 280.

- It formulated **Five-Year Plans** from **1951**.
- **Ashok Chanda** called it the **"Economic Cabinet of India"**. Ashok Chanda applied that label to the **Planning Commission** (योजना आयोग).
- The **National Development Council** was set up on **6 August 1952**.
- It had the PM, Chief Ministers and Planning Commission members. It approved plans. It was extra-constitutional.
- Official **poverty line** estimates (प्राकलन समिति) of that era were fixed by the **Planning Commission**. The **Planning Commission** (now NITI Aayog) fixed official poverty-line estimates of that era.
- The successor machinery is NITI-era, not Lok Sabha or Cabinet as a line-drawing body.
- It was replaced by **NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015**.

- NITI is a think-tank of cooperative federalism. It has **no** binding Five-Year Plan allocation like the old Commission.
- The first Vice-Chairperson was **Arvind Panagariya**. **Arvind Panagariya** was the first NITI Aayog Vice-Chairperson; Rajiv Kumar came later.
- **Industrial Policy Resolution 1948** set a mixed economy.
- **Avadi 1955** spoke of a **socialistic pattern of society**.
- **Industrial Policy Resolution 1956** put the commanding heights with the public sector.

> **Logic:** PC ≠ Finance Commission. NITI ≠ renamed PC with the same plan-power. First NITI VC = **Panagariya**, not Rajiv Kumar.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q144)**: Ashok Chandra (former Comptroller and Auditor General) described the **Planning Commission** as the "Economic Cabinet" of India.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q115)**: The **Planning Commission (now NITI Aayog)** was responsible for calculating and fixing the poverty line in India through expert task forces (Alagh, Lakdawala, Tendulkar, Rangarajan).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q67)**: **Arvind Panagariya** was appointed as the first Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog in January 2015.

15.8 Five-Year Plans

Plan	Years	Key fact
1st	1951–56	Agriculture, irrigation, CDP; Harrod–Domar / K.N. Raj
2nd	1956–61	**Mahalanobis**; heavy industry; **Bhilai (USSR), Rourkela (West Germany), Durgapur (UK)**
3rd	1961–66	Self-reliance; hit by wars and drought
Plan Holiday	1966–69	Three annual plans
4th	1969–74	Growth with stability (Gadgil)
5th	1974–79	Garibi Hatao; ended early (1978)
Rolling	1978–80	Janata interlude
6th	1980–85	Poverty / modernisation
7th	1985–90	Food, work, productivity
Annual	1990–92	Crisis years
8th	1992–97	Liberalisation (Rao–Manmohan)
9th	1997–2002	Growth with social justice

Plan	Years	Key fact
10th	2002–07	8% growth target
11th	2007–12	Inclusive growth
12th	2012–17	**Faster, sustainable and more inclusive growth**

- The **12th Plan was the last** Five-Year Plan.
- After that came NITI-era strategy documents, not a 13th Plan of the old type.

> **Logic:** Sustainable-growth slogan = **12th**, not 11th. Steel plants = **2nd Plan**. CDP = **1st Plan**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q40)**: The **12th Five-Year Plan (2012–2017)** was launched with the core objective of *"Faster, More Inclusive and Sustainable Growth."*

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
Etawah Pilot	**1948**, **Albert Mayer**, **Mahewa**, Etawah district — national CDP model
UP in 1950 map	**Part A** state (former United Provinces)
Uttarakhand	Carved from UP, **9 November 2000**